



GRMR

How a Story Works: Setting, Events, Characterization, Conflict, and Plot

CPALM Standards

- ELA.4.R.1.1 Explain how setting, events, conflict, and character development contribute to the plot in a literary text.
- ELA.5.R.1.1 Analyze how setting, events, conflict, and characterization contribute to the plot in a literary text.



Learning Goals

Today we will learn....

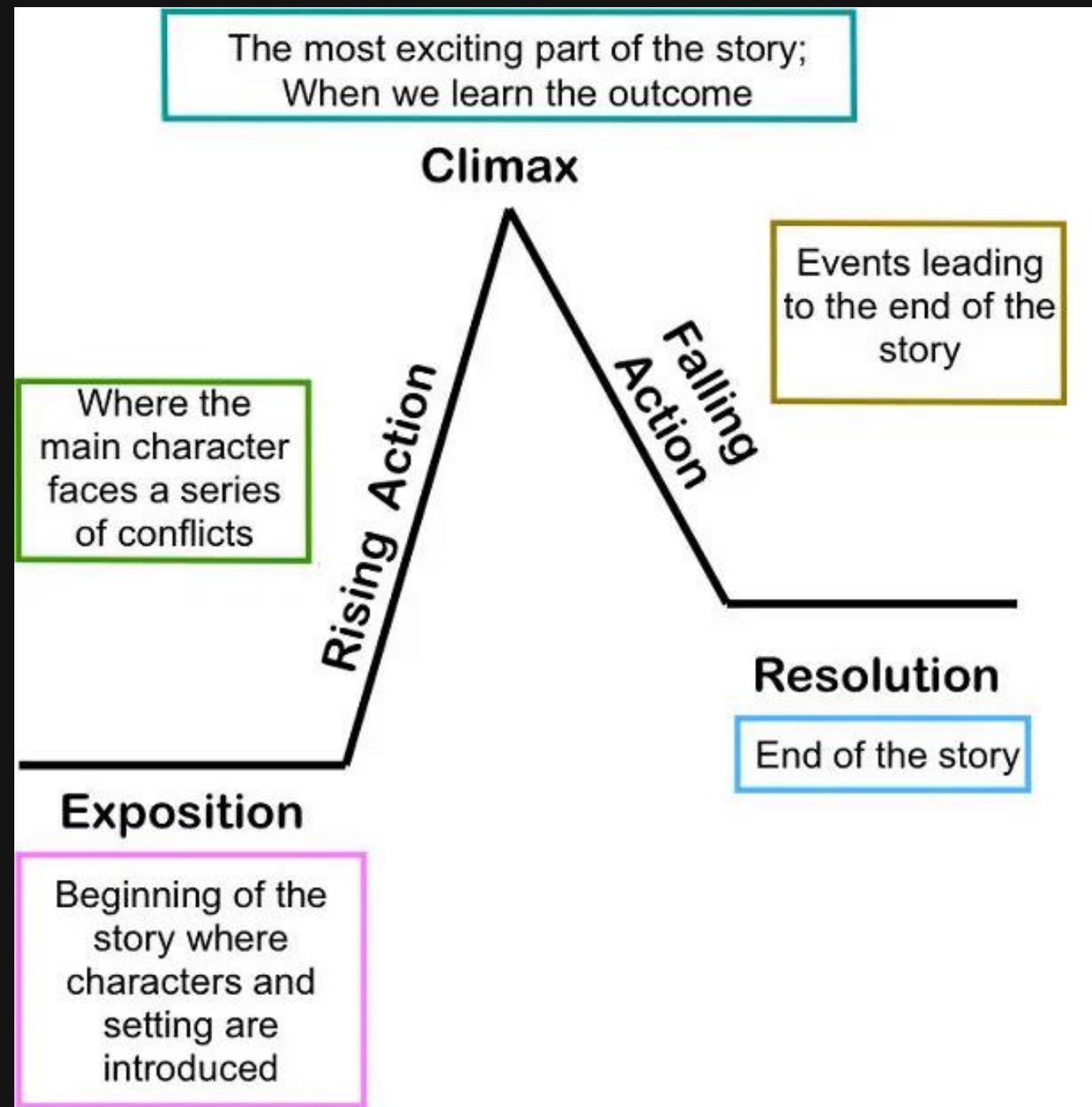
How setting, events, characterization, and conflict development work together to build a story's plot.

Success Criteria:

- ✓ I can identify the setting, events, characterization, and conflict in a story
- ✓ I can explain how they work together to build the plot



What is plot?



DEFINITION

Plot is the sequence of main events that happen in a story.



**Let's Practice! Watch this
video to identify the elements
of plot.**





Identify the.....

1. Exposition
2. Rising Action
3. Climax
4. Falling Action
5. Resolution



Elements of a Story

Setting - where and when the story happens

Events - the key actions that move the story forward

Characterization - how the author reveals who a character is

Conflict - the main problem or challenge



The elements of a story help to
inform and develop the plot



Setting:

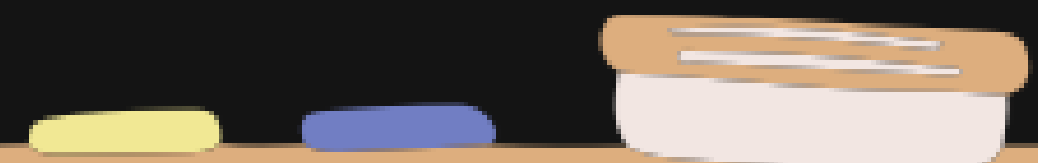
DEFINITION

The **time** and **place** of a story.



Questions to consider when reading:

- Where does the story happen?
- When does it take place?
- How does the setting affect the story?



A playground
during Winter

**Lets Practice! What is the
setting in this picture?**



Events:

DEFINITION

The key actions that move the story forward



Things to consider:

- Events happen through cause and effect
- They come together to create the plot
- Some events are more important than others



Characterization:

DEFINITION

How the author reveals who a character is.



How does the author
do this?

- Thoughts: "I can't believe I'm doing this..." shows a character is nervous
- Actions: He hid the letter - shows a character is secretive
- Dialogue: "We'll figure it out together" shows teamwork





**Lets Practice! What does this
action reveal about the
character in the purple shirt?**



The character is
mean, aggressive,
and a bully



Conflict:

DEFINITION

The main problem or challenge in a story



What types of conflict
are there?

- Character vs Self: the character has an internal struggle such as facing a fear or making a decision
- Character vs Character: when two characters in a story have a problem or disagreement that puts them against each other such as a hero and a villain



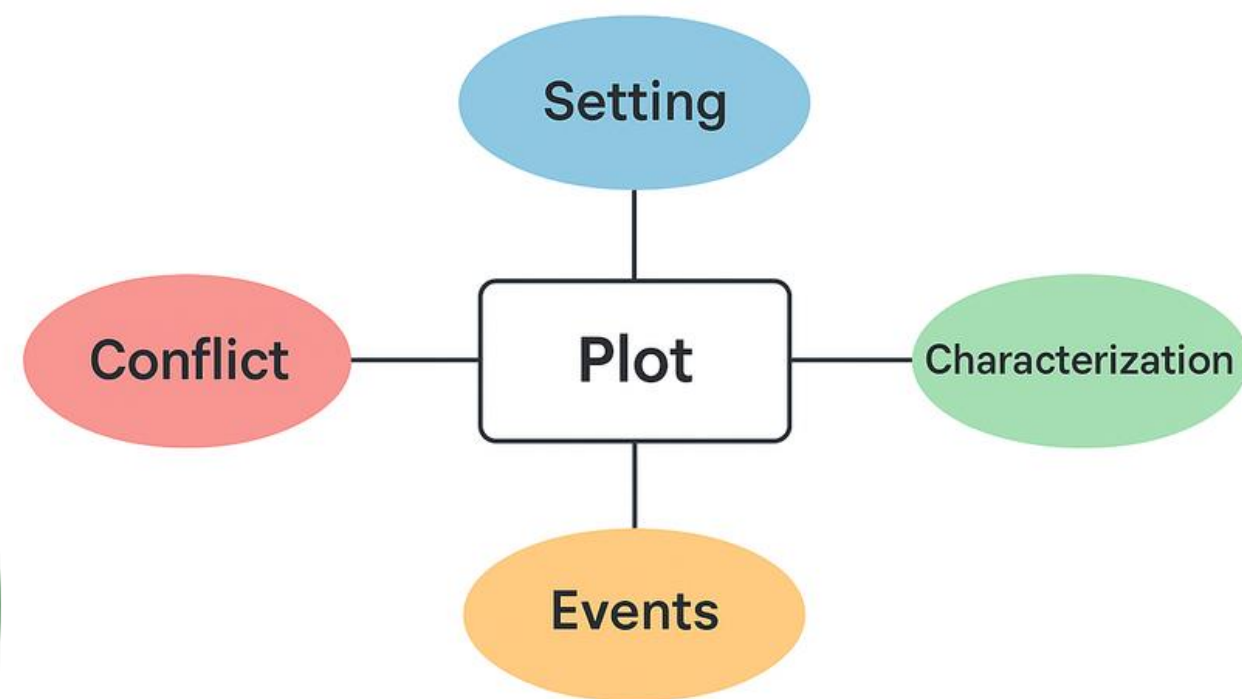
Lets Practice!

Can you think of a story you know that has character vs self conflict? What about character vs character conflict?



Putting it all together

How Story Elements Work Together
to Build the Plot



EXAMPLE

Because the story takes place during a hurricane (setting), the main character has to face their fear of storms (conflict), which shows their bravery (characterization) and leads to the climax (plot).



Passage Practice



The wind howled outside as Maya tightened her raincoat and looked out the window. The school bus hadn't come, and puddles were already forming on the street. She glanced at the science project sitting on the table — the one she and her best friend Leo had spent all week building.

"If I don't bring it in today, we'll both fail," she muttered.

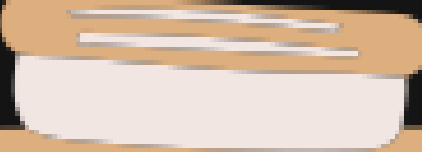
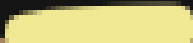
Her mom called from the kitchen, "Maya, it's too dangerous to walk in this storm!"

Maya hesitated. She didn't want to disappoint Leo, but the thunder made her flinch. Taking a deep breath, she grabbed an umbrella, tucked the project under her arm, and stepped into the rain.

The wind pushed against her, but she kept moving. When she finally reached the school, soaked but smiling, Leo met her at the door.

"You actually came!" he said. "You saved us."

Maya grinned. "No storm's stronger than teamwork."





Follow-Up Questions



Lets discuss!

1. What is the **setting** and how does it affect the story's problem?
2. What is the main **conflict** Maya faces?
3. How do Maya's actions show her character traits?
4. What **events** move the story towards its resolution?
5. How do these elements work together to build the **plot**?



What if the story changed?

How would the story change if...

1. The setting was different?
2. Maya decided not to go to school?
3. There was no conflict?



Every story is built like a puzzle - the setting, characterization, events, and conflict all fit together to create the plot. When we understand how they connect, we can better understand the story.



An illustration of a classroom scene. In the center is a large black chalkboard with an orange border. On the chalkboard, the words "Thank you!" are written in a large, light green, sans-serif font, underlined with two white lines. To the left of the chalkboard, a female teacher with brown hair, wearing a pink dress, holds a stack of three books. To the right, a male student with dark hair, wearing a blue and orange striped shirt, holds a green chalk and has just finished drawing a purple squiggle on the board. Below the chalkboard is a green desk with a brown pencil and an orange apple on it. The background consists of vertical green stripes.

Thank you!

Great work today!!!

-- GRMR Team